CSOPartnership for Development Effectiveness

NARRATIVE REPORT TEMPLATE

Type of Reports (in English)	Supporting documents
Campaign outputs	▪ National state of civic space ▪ Full documentation of proceedings ▪ Research reports and key findings ▪ Information, education, communication (IEC) materials ▪ Policy and advocacy products
Narrative Report	▪ Narrative report summary
Financial Report	▪ Official receipts and invoices (in English) ▪ Financial report summary (in English)

Narrative Report Summary

I. Basic Information

Title of the action:	**MULTISTAKEHOLDERS' CAMPAIGN AGAINST SHRINKING AND CLOSE CIVIC SPACE IN NIGERIA**
Proponent:	CAFSO-WRAG for Development in collaboration with Civil Society Coalition on Sustainable Development
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Country of implementation:	Nigeria
Region:	West Africa

II. Activity

Key Activity 1: For each activity, describe separately by answering the following questions:

- What is the title of the activity?

Internet campaigning raising awareness on the shrinking civic space and human rights violation

- What are the objectives of the activity?

(a) to create more awareness on the shrinking space for CSOs so as for government to reverse the trend.

(b) to increase, broaden, and expand CSO constituencies in advancing CSO enabling environment, and monitoring EDC principles and implementation.

- When and where did the activity take place?

From December 2, 2020 to January 12, 2021 (it is continuous as we have created a special twitter account for "shrinking civic space"); the activity is both online (Facebook, twitter, instagram, and coalition websites) and physical in Ibadan, Nigeria, West Africa.

- Who were the participants of the activity and their gender?

Apart from over 40 participants who attended the capacity building, there could be an estimated over 10 million persons who are still participating/reading online using those social media mentioned above. But for the physical meeting, the participants were drawn from NYCN (Youth Group), CDA, CISGHAN,

CPN, Academia, Human Rights Group, and CSCSD membership. Since this is an online campaign, it is difficult to disagregate the gender.

- How was the activity objectives achieved?

The objective was to create more awareness which the project has successfully done through the social and physical media and the responses from various individuals making comments on our Facebook, twitting and re-twitting our #shrinkingcivicspace while our activities were all reported in traditional and online newspapers (attached).

- Please provide brief description of the activity.

Our country action was (is also) raising awareness through the social (using Twitter, Facebook, web updates, whatsapp) and traditional media (newspapers) campaign actions on the shrinking space for CSOs in Nigeria. We specifically asked for the need to release those that government have detained including Sowore (Publisher of online medium *Sahara Reporters*) and the teenage musician. We used the internet campaign to raise awareness on the shrinking space for CSOs and human rights violation by government and the need to #endSARS. Contents were created both in Facebook and twitter.

Key Activity 2: For each activity, describe separately by answering the following questions:

- What is the title of the activity?

Multi-stakeholders policy/advocacy training on shrinking civic space, enabling environment for CSOs, monitoring EDC principles and implementation.

- What are the objectives of the activity?

(a) To strengthen CPDE membership with policy advocacy skills on the issue of shrinking civic space.
(b) To increase, broaden, and expand CSO constituencies in advancing CSO enabling environment, and monitoring EDC principles and implementation.
(c) To engage relevant national development cooperation actors on the status of implementing the international commitments.
(d) To present before government specific demands reversing the trend of shrinking and closing civic space in particular seeking sanctions against erring security operatives (#endSARS and #5for5).

- When and where did the activity take place?

From December 2, 2020 to January 15, 2021 Ibadan and Abuja, Nigeria, West Africa (indeed, it is continuous as we need to have post-project follow up).

- Who were the participants of the activity and their gender?

Participants cut across NYCN (Youth Group), CDA, CISGHAN, CPN, Academia, Human Rights Group, and CSCSD membership. About 42 participants attended the capacity building broken down into 25 men and 17 ladies with three government officials.

- How was the activity objectives achieved?

(e) The objective was to create more awareness and strengthen CPDE membership with policy advocacy skills on the issue of shrinking civic space, among others. The objective was achieved because not less than forty civil society actors were trained and enlightened on

different scales of shrinking space for them and how to tackle the debacle. Furthermore, towards the end of the workshop, there was a launching of an enlarged CPDE Nigeria chapter resulting into institutionalizing CPDE National Advocacy Group on EDC being the first of its kind in Africa. This activity contributed to the project objective - *To increase, broaden, and expand CSO constituencies in advancing CSO enabling environment, and monitoring EDC principles and implementation*.

All the 40 participants pledged their support to advance the cause of EDC in Nigeria. As a result, many more civil society organizations are engaging in shrinking civic space advocacy and advancing broaden activism on CSO enabling environment in Nigeria.

Our objective was further achieved with the presence of the government official, Honourable Kunle Yusuff who is the Senior Special Adviser to the government on Sustainable Development Goals. Indeed, he collected on behalf of the government the signed copy of "CSO Key Asks on CSO Enabling Environment" a petition asking government to reverse the shrinking civic space in Nigeria and provide us enabling environment to do our work as development actors in our own right.

- Please provide brief description of the activity.

Apart from our country level action raising awareness through the social (using Twitter, Facebook, web updates, whatsapp) and traditional media (newspapers), the capacity building on the shrinking space for CSOs in Nigeria was also intended to raise awareness on the shrinking civic space. This one-day training was meant for sectoral and constituency groups of not less than 40 participants who after the training are expected to be more enlightened on different scales of shrinking space for them and how to tackle the debacle. The training also strengthened their skills in conducting action, mass mobilization, and other activities geared at influencing relevant official policies, programmes or processes. A practical demonstration of this took place as the participants took to the streets carrying placards with different inscriptions asking governments to uphold human rights, release those civic actors in detention and reverse the shrinking space trend in Nigeria.

In addition, 24 participants signed on to the petition presented to the government representative on CSO Key Asks on CSO Enabling Environment. The crowning effort of the activity was the expanding CSO constituencies in advancing CSO enabling environment, and monitoring EDC principles and implementation. As people showed keen interest in EDC, elections were conducted into nine offices decided by the participants themselves. Here below is the full list of **CPDE NIGERIA NATIONAL EDC ADVOCACY LEADERSHIP:**

1. Lilian Ezenwa - National Chairperson (Abia, SE)
2. Abdurrahman Akindele Ayuba- National Vice President (Kwara, NC)
3. Edwin Asibor - Secretary (Edo, SS)
4. Deborah Salami - Assistant Secretary (Oyo, SW)
5. Bolarinwa Olabode - Public Relations Officer (Osun, SW)
6. Ada Unyime - Treasurer (Abuja, FCT)
7. Ikenna Ugwu - Research & Development officer (Enugu, SE)
8. Thaddeus Ugoh -Fundraising Coordinator (Abuja, FCT)
9. Joseph Adeboye - Media/ICT officer (Ede, SW)

After this was the launching of an enlarged CPDE Nigeria chapter resulting into institutionalizing CPDE National Advocacy Group on EDC, being the first of its kind in Africa. As a result of this enlarged CPDE Nigeria, the nine-member Executive Committee set up WhatsApp platforms (one for the Exco, the other for the general membership of CPDE) for further engagement after the termination of the project.

III. Output

- For each output, describe separately by briefly answering the following questions:
  - What are the outputs produced by the activity?
  - Series of strategy planning meetings: These were done towards the country level actions. It was used to plan on the key project deliverables such as timelines, identification of participant, media houses including online publishers to use, the writing of the press release, the main workshop etc.
  - Press conference: This was done in order to create awareness on the shrinking civic space and on EDC principles. Copies of the press statement (link provided below) by the Principal Coordinator were made available to the press. The press conference whose outcome was published in some papers took place days before the workshop itself.
  - There was the multi-stakeholders policy/advocacy training involving youth group, CDA, CISGHAN, CPN, Human Rights Group, CSCSD on shrinking civic space, enabling environment for CSOs, monitoring EDC principles and implementation. Forty development actors were trained while they all pledged commitment to Istanbul Principles and advocating EDC principles.
  - There was also the internet campaign raising awareness on the shrinking space for CSOs and human rights violation by government and the need to #endSARS. The project deployed both social (using Twitter, Facebook, web updates, whatsapp) and traditional media (newspapers) in the campaign actions.
  - The project came up with a petition to the President and Commander-in-Chief of the Armed Forces of Nigeria Muhammadu Buhari on the need to reverse the shrinking civic space. Adapted to suit our country level socio-political environment was the extract from CPDE Civil Society Manifesto for Effective Development Cooperation: CSO Key Asks on CSO Enabling Environment (p.15). The CSO Key Asks was received in person by the representative of the government at a small presentation during the workshop.
  - Letter to the Ministry of Budget and National Planning and Department for International Cooperation on the status of implementing the international commitments so as to gauge their initiatives' alignment with the EDC principles. The letter was taken to the Ministry in Abuja.
  - Launching of an enlarged CPDE Nigeria chapter. Participants at the workshop showed enthusiasm in CPDE and its work on EDC. They then came up with the idea of resuscitating CPDE Nigeria by agreeing on conducting elections for its leadership. Thus, the workshop produced a nine-member CPDE National Advocacy Group on EDC, and set up two WhatsApp platforms.
  - In a bid to strengthen our awareness campaign, assorted IEC posters and fliers were produced. Apart from freely distributing these IEC materials, they were also used as training materials during the workshop. Of interest was the commitment of the participants to the outcome of the training by deciding to go to streets (the same day) demonstrating what they had learnt especially in using IEC materials as a tool for advocacy.
  - In summary, the following were produced: *banners, press statement, copies of Belgrade Call to Action, Istanbul CSO Development Effectiveness Principles, Nigeria's Third Monitoring Round Results, CSO Key Asks, Key papers – (key note address, Effects of shrinking space, advocacy strategy, Nigeria and GPEDC) -, communiqué, posters (Security brutality #ENDSARS, and Dimensions of shrinking civic space and human rights violations), photographs , etc*

  - How were the outputs used after the activity?

(a) Copies of the press statement by the Principal Coordinator were made available to the press. The press statement was published in some papers (link provided below) for governments and populace to be sensitized to the shrinking civic space.

(b) The workshop led to the launching of an enlarged CPDE Nigeria chapter resulting into institutionalizing CPDE National Advocacy Group on EDC, being the first of its kind in Africa. Nine-member Executive Committee set up the WhatsApp platforms (one for the Exco, the other for the general membership of CPDE) for further engagement after the termination of the project.

(c) After the project deployed both social (using Twitter, Facebook, web updates, whatsapp) and traditional media (newspapers) in the campaign actions, there is an intensive campaign on shrinking civic space and EDC principles by different people using our social media especially WhatsApp (from initial 30 to 100 members), Facebook and twitter with close to 50 followers as at the last check (link also provided below).

(d) The government representative who collected The CSO Key Asks in person during the workshop promised to deliver the letter to the authority. We hope to do a follow up later to monitor governments' commitment to EDC principles and Key Asks.

(e) The assorted IEC posters and fliers produced were not only distributed during our street peaceful procession but also copies were given to the participants who are going to be using the materials on their campaign in their various towns and cities.

(f) We are still doing follow up on the letter to the Ministry of Budget and National Planning and Department for International Cooperation on the status of implementing the international commitments. Update shall be given when we receive concrete response from Abuja.

- How were the outputs disseminated?

Apart from sharing papers presented on shrinking civic space and EDC – *Nigeria's 3rd Monitoring Round Results,* the outputs like communiqué, key note address, CSO Key Asks were disseminated through traditional (newspapers) and various online media. The outputs such as our banners, posters and fliers were also placed on various websites, twitter and Facebook. We also gave to the participants copious IEC materials for onward distribution to their colleagues and partners in development. Some of them promised using the materials during their own step-up training.

IV. Results*

- What outcomes result from activities and outputs?
  - CSOs becoming more enlightened on different scales of shrinking space for them and how to tackle the debacle.
  - Many more civil society organizations are engaging in shrinking civic space advocacy, and advancing activism on CSO enabling environment in Nigeria.
  - Increase in new sectoral/constituency groups (such as Youth group, CDA, CISGHAN, CPN, Joint National Association of Persons with Disabilities, Human Rights Group, and CSCSD) joining CPDE Nigeria.
  - CSOs including human rights activists and the press are further positioned to vigorously campaign on the release of those detained by government especially those actors that various courts in Nigeria have been mandated by government to release them.
  - We campaigned for the release of both Omoyele Sowore and Omar Farouk, the teenage musician who had been sentenced to 10 years imprisonment for blasphemy. Though the court eventually freed Omar (link provided in the box below) we contributed to his regaining his freedom through our campaign while Sowore has been charged to court.

V. Other Information

- National state of civic space (a paper presented on this is attached below)

- Full documentation of proceedings (attached)
- Information, education, communication (IEC) materials (attached)
- Policy and advocacy products (attached)

VI. Lessons Learned

- What worked well in the National Campaign?

Everything worked well as planned. Though invitation was extended to both legislature and executive, three government officials from the executive attended, one of them was strategic to our workshop. We had also planned for 30 participants but we had to overshoot to forty because of great enthusiasm CSO actors showed. This added to the success of the project as there was a wider participation of CSOs and wider dissemination of the project outcome across the country.

- What could be improved in the campaign implementation?

We would have preferred two days of intensive training. Paucity of funds did not allow for this. However, we are grateful to SIDA through CPDE for providing the funds but expect they increase this next time for more effective and result-oriented training.

Secondly, funds, however little, should come at the right time. We did not receive a cent for this project up till the time of writing this report. We secured a loan elsewhere with the hope to repay when CPDE releases the fund. When we contacted GS in Philippines, we were told that the RoA Africa Regional Secretariat said they sent the first tranche to us in December 2020 but it was returned to them. However, up till now RoA has not consulted us to explain the reason for the return. Regional Secretariat should improve their communication strategy with the partners.

Thirdly, we encourage the GS to always contact the successful partners in good time so as to allow the partners enough time to plan. It was on December 2, when we received information that our application was successful which made us work behind schedule. We couldn't do much in December which led us to organize our workshop in January against the approved timelines. Adherence to timeline is important.

- What other factors not anticipated that had impact on the attainment of objectives?
  (a) We did not envisage the need to go on procession - a method in campaigning. As a result of the skills acquired by the participants, they all decided to demonstrate that knowledge by going to the streets in procession displaying the posters and distributing the fliers. This tends to have positive impact on the outcome of the project and on individual actors themselves as many people not invited to the workshop got to know about the project.
  (b) The presence of the Senior Special Adviser to the Government on SDGs at our workshop was a great opportunity for us to send him to the government. Twenty four key NGOs quickly signed against the names of their NGOs the letter on CSO Key Asks on CSO Enabling Environment which we had prepared to send to the government. The picture of the government official was taken along with two key members of the CSOs who made the official presentation.

VII. Visibility

- Please provide **direct links** to all the materials produced. Please add more rows if necessary.

Title	Link
CSOs demand concrete	https://www.itrealms.com.ng/2021/01/csos-demand-concrete-steps-

steps against shrinking civic space – ITREALMS	against.html
Key note address on Shrinking civic space	https://penpushing.com.ng/for-the-record-multi-stakeholders-campaign-against-shrinking-and-closing-civic-space-in-nigeria-being-a-key-note-address-by-dr-tola-winjobi-principal-coordinator-cafso-wra/
Communiqué on Shrinking Civic Space	https://thenigerianpost.com.ng/2021/01/12/communique-issued-by-participants-at-the-end-of-a-one-day-national-multistakeholders-workshop-on-shrinking-and-close-civic-space-in-nigeria-organised-by-cafso-wrag-for-development-in-collaboration-wi/
Governments: Take concrete steps to reverse trends of shrinking and closing civic spaces in Nigeria, By Tola Winjobi	https://newspeakonline.com/governments-take-concrete-steps-to-reverse-trends-of-shrinking-and-closing-civic-spaces-in-nigeria-by-tola-winjobi/
Stop intimidating #EndSARS promoters, supporters, group tells FG	https://newspeakonline.com/stop-intimidating-endsars-promoters-supporters-group-tells-fg/
Fight Insurgency and Stop Intimidating #EndSARS Frontliners and Supporters - CSCSD	https://thenigerianpost.com.ng/2020/11/17/fight-insurgency-and-stop-intimidating-endsars-frontliners-and-supporters-cscsd/
Blasphemy: Court frees 13-year-old, orders retrial of musician sentenced to death	https://www.prestigenewsonline.com/blasphemy-court-frees-13-year-old-orders-retrial-of-musician-sentenced-to-death/
Video: Social Media Bill in 2 minutes	*https://bit.ly/2NMqGqZ ; https://bit.ly/39xvFUw ; https://bit.ly/39zOnL2*
TwitterCSCSD	https://twitter.com/CSCSD_National
👉**Facebook:**	http://bit.ly/2XvGAXY Handle/Username: @cpdenigeria
👉**Twitter:**	http://bit.ly/2LhA6cX Handle/Username: @cpdenigeria
👉**Instagram:**	https://bit.ly/3bRk6sV Handle/Username: @cpdenigeria

VIII. List of Annexes

- Please list down and provide a direct **link to the folder** of the annexed documents.

Full documentation of proceedings:
https://drive.google.com/file/d/1g2wDyre235TbkStyrt6EynONgBwUJw2I/view?usp=sharing

Banner: https://drive.google.com/file/d/1nKL61Nyt_DQ22eU_5CZmTLWAdWquTzSI/view?usp=sharing ; http://bit.ly/3os0y0O

Rollup Banner on Shrinking civic space:
https://drive.google.com/file/d/11odmA58OYEc0DhTVE_88XkEUaxbboOIE/view?usp=sharing

press statement:
https://drive.google.com/file/d/1Fj_7GV94xYJw_yK25w3hdIU34p5GOSsK/view?usp=sharing

Letter to Mr President on CSO Key Asks on EE:
https://drive.google.com/file/d/1Rnbzz9kJtd3p9Zilf8DI4yKOlabNoOaZ/view?usp=sharing

Winjobi's Key note address: https://drive.google.com/file/d/1JDKgPF14NwR-u8DrbfyaSxMFCN2HS6I1/view?usp=sharing

Olasupo's Paper on Effects of shrinking space:
https://drive.google.com/file/d/1lbVn73S977m3ENcSlM0JD4Ftm7CrpRA2/view?usp=sharing

Oyeniyi's Paper on Nigeria and GPEDC:
https://drive.google.com/file/d/1Ppu1lhVK38ErR3T0JAD3lw9jZrJpe57T/view?usp=sharing

Nigeria and GPEDC Assessment: https://drive.google.com/file/d/1Ez6vuSpaatA-8YcETCgrO056sOfJTjQa/view?usp=sharing

Paper on Development Effectiveness and CPDE:
https://drive.google.com/file/d/1UE5pjgMqAVuuqVEsYhrusAZXSnqdHV9i/view?usp=sharing

The Belgrade Call to Action: https://drive.google.com/file/d/1ERl86bYqkKMQTidziIOf7QaP-XAATJtf/view?usp=sharing

Istanbul CSO Development Effectiveness Principles: https://drive.google.com/file/d/1pQB-JYfOu7uFCBCAG04V0RJN-TZhI2Mb/view?usp=sharing

Nigeria's Third Monitoring Round Results: https://drive.google.com/file/d/1JDKgPF14NwR-u8DrbfyaSxMFCN2HS6I1/view?usp=sharing

Communiquéon Shrinking Civic Space: https://drive.google.com/file/d/11bI-UKwKw66z526cMlQblWTPAlQZ0WsF/view?usp=sharing

Poster - Security brutality #ENDSARS: https://drive.google.com/file/d/1-fZYx7NEp_Ds76_4LgpNvxjZHmG3NMSh/view?usp=sharing

Poster - Dimensions of shrinking civic space and human rights violations:
https://drive.google.com/file/d/1bJbxOcOvokG_W5HR-BBmzorAqNkTAsF6/view?usp=sharing

SOCIAL MEDIA BILL (Hate Speech Bill) in two minutes: https://bit.ly/2NMgGgZ ; https://bit.ly/39xvFUw ; https://bit.ly/39zOnL2 https://www.instagram.com/p/CKrnv6THrEG/

SAMPLES OF PICTURES TAKEN AT THE WORKSHOP:

https://drive.google.com/file/d/1lKi4ja3Ps-AidBw6ZXGBcV8f8d80X7hO/view?usp=sharing

23% 11:22 PM
CPDE Nigeria
6 Tweets
Tweets
Tweets & replies
Media
Likes
CPDE Nigeria @cpdenigeria · 14m
Honourable Kunle Yusuf, Special Adviser to the Oyo State Governor on SDGs at the campaign against #ShrinkingCivicSpace
ULTI-STAKEHOLDERS' CAMPAIGN AGAINST SHRINKING AND CLOSE CIVIC SPACE IN NIGERIA
CPDE Nigeria @cpdenigeria · 20m
Peaceful #Procession staged to campaign against the #ShrinkingCivicSpace in Nigeria
@CSCSD_National
@CSOPartnership_
@AmnestyNigeria
@hrw

Registration on going at the shrinking civic space workshop

Demonstration against shrinking civic space in Nigeria